> resented by non-governmental organizations, the academic community, independent experts and merely concerned citizens contribute significantly to the transparency, monitoring and evaluation, as well as supervision over the performance outcomes and fulfillment of the commitments undertaken by the Member States. Involvement of the civil society in the discussion of BRICS agenda is extremely important not only to provide the leaders with an opportunity to look at the problems from the viewpoints of different groups of the population and, consequently, to make decisions based on their views and interests, but as well to make decisions made at the Summit more legitimate and … from the point of view of an adequate retranslation of both decisions and commitments made by the leaders as well as BRICS performance deliverables to the international community.

Civilised society will thus support BRICS monitoring, evaluation, legitimation, 'retranslation' – but have nothing to do with expression of grievances and demands. (The same was true of the management of the BRICS Academic Forum and the association of civilized society think tanks, whose ideas and constituencies would not rock any boats.) Yet in the real world of the BRICS countries, there was an exceptional level of discontent as the BRICS came into being.

- Brazil hosted the BRICS Summit in July 2014, two days after the World Cup ended and just over a year after millions of protesters expressed rage about, first, public sector transport fare increases, and then, increasingly, about Sepp Blatter's politically destructive relationship with Workers Party president Dilma Rousseff (Bond 2013). Police repression was extreme, and after a while far-right forces used the opportunity to mobilise political attacks on the Workers Party and indeed on many protest participants of the left.
- Challenges also come from Russia, as a result not only of expansion into Ukraine (which, though popular in polling terms, did attract a small anti-war movement), but repression of protests. Civil society has been courageous in that authoritarian context: a democracy movement in late 2011, a freedom of expression battle involving a risqué rock band in 2012, gay rights in 2013 and at the Winter Olympics, and anti-war protests in March 2014.
- In India, activists shook the power structure over corruption in 2011–12, a high-profile rape-murder in late 2012, and municipal electoral surprises by a left-populist anti-establishment political party in late 2013 and early 2015.